

Federal Government Resources

The federal government runs a huge toolbox for small businesses — funding databases, free data, and official help. Below are the key national resources. Tick the box once you've explored each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

These are the official .gov tools the pros use. They're all free. Bookmark them — they're where real grants, contracts, and trusted guidance live.

1 Funding & Contracts Databases

The official places to find federal money and contracts.

☐ Grants.gov

Search and apply for 1,000+ federal grant programs.

→ www.grants.gov

☐ SAM.gov

Register here (free) to do business with the government and find contracts.

→ sam.gov

☐ SBA — Funding Programs

SBA's hub for loans, investment, and grant facts.

→ www.sba.gov/funding-programs

2 Research & Innovation

Federal R&D funding for innovative businesses.

☐ SBIR.gov

The portal for federal research-and-development grants (check current authorization status).

→ www.sbir.gov

3 Free Business Data & Tools

Government data that helps you plan and find customers.

☐ Census Business Builder

Free market data to size up customers and competition in any area.

→ www.census.gov/data/data-tools/cbb.html

☐ USA.gov — Business Resources

The government's plain-language hub linking every business resource.

→ www.usa.gov/business

4 Official Help & Mentoring

Free, trusted help from federal partners.

☐ SBA Local Assistance Finder

Find every SBA-funded advisor, lender, and center near you.

→ www.sba.gov/local-assistance/find

☐ SCORE

Free mentoring from experienced business volunteers.

→ www.score.org

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Registering on SAM.gov is always FREE — ignore sites that charge to “register” you. Only use official .gov addresses; many look-alike sites charge for free government services.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Even if you’re not chasing contracts yet, a free SAM.gov registration and a look at Census Business Builder can sharpen your plan and reveal opportunities.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national tools. For help using these databases or finding state programs, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
